

Zirui Zhao

Product Design

Multidisciplinary designer and developer studying Computer Science at the University of Waterloo, working where visual design meets front-end code. Handles brand identity and advertising for BCRC Montreal, Brave Hearts Alliance and freelance clients. Designs in Figma and Adobe Creative Suite with close attention to typography and how a layout guides the eye, and can build those designs out as accessible, responsive front-end code.

Experience

Brave Hearts Alliance / Co-founder & Designer

July 2025 – Present

Developed scalable visual identity systems across print & digital channels (30,000+ reach); directed creative strategy for fundraising campaigns generating \$220,000+; orchestrated partnerships with 5+ organizations to deliver large-scale awareness campaigns.

BCRC Montreal / Design Intern

June 2025 – August 2025

Led digital marketing and graphic design initiatives reaching 20K+ residents (700% engagement increase), designed high-volume brand-led design assets, promoted social services to 200+ families.

McGill University / Research Assistant

April 2025 – Present

Engineered Python pipelines using lxml to parse 50,000+ keystroke data points from raw XML files; and co-authored quantitative research accepted to the 2026 CPA conference correlating computational metrics with bilingual language processing.

Freelance / Graphic Designer & Illustrator

November 2022 – Present

Directed a creative team of 16 in apparel production generating \$14,000+. Led visual strategy for publications reaching 300,000+.

Marianopolis College / Vice Chair of Communications

August 2025 – May 2026

Directed monthly ad campaigns via Adobe Creative Suite (30% engagement growth), orchestrated campus-wide brand messaging, and supervised 36 creatives across 100+ publications.

Zirui Zhao
z457zhao@uwaterloo.ca
www.zirui.ca
+1 514 919 6899
[/in/zirui.ca](https://in.zirui.ca)

Education

University of Waterloo

September 2026 – April 2030

Bachelor of Computer Science, HCI
Product Designer, PRISM Collective

Marianopolis College

August 2024 – May 2026

DEC, Pure & Applied Sciences
Dean's List, 2024-2026
Mental Health Mentor, IGNITE

CalArts

Certificate of Extended Studies, Design

Awards

CPA 2026 - Poster Presentation
Odyssey de l'objet 2024 - Best Theme
MariHacks Hackathon 2025 - First Place

Skills

Brand Identity • Graphic Design • Editorial & Layout • Illustration • Animation • Print Production • Advertising Strategy • UI/UX Design • Wireframing & Prototyping • Web Design • Accessibility • Adobe CC • Figma • HTML/CSS • Python • Generative AI • Asana • Strategic Communication • Style Guides

Languages:

English (Fluent)
French (Fluent)
Chinese (Advanced)